SOC-02 | Therapist only - all age groups

Listening and checking an interpretation

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Separate what was said or observed from the meaning given to it, and choose whether and how to clarify. Listen to the content and need without claiming that a single cue reveals another person's thoughts.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

Eye contact, a uniform rule for body language, or hiding one's communication style are not required. Do not dismiss reported harm as merely an interpretation. Clarifying with a threatening person is not a practice task.

Reusing existing material

SOC-01 offers a request and boundary. Here we explore the message before a response and a clarifying question. Existing core sheets can support broader exploration of a thought when needed.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: Tamar receives a brief reply from a friend and thinks she is angry. She chooses a convenient time to ask whether they can talk, and finds she still lacks enough information about the intention.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

What exact message do I want to understand?

2 | Question for discussion

Which parts are facts, and which are my interpretation?

3 | Question for discussion

What differences in context or communication might matter?

4 | Question for discussion

What clarifying question would help the conversation?

5 | Question for discussion

Is it safe and appropriate to clarify directly or in another way?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

Sometimes the other person's intention cannot be known. Allow uncertainty without forcing a positive explanation. When there are signs of harm, assess safety as well as interpretation.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

Use a short, familiar conversation. Two dolls or a drawing can help; a safe adult supports clarification without deciding what the child should have felt.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Include brief messages where tone and context are missing. Do not request disclosure of private conversations or assume a delayed reply means rejection.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Explore differences in culture, language, authority and style. Listening may involve writing, processing time or alternative communication, without requiring eye contact.

OA | Older adults

Ask what supports understanding: pace, wording, writing or hearing conditions. Do not assume confusion or reduced ability because of age.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

Choose an everyday conversation with a safe person, or practice only a fictional example. Not clarifying is an option; messages, names or another person's information are not required.

At the next session

Explore whether separating the message from its interpretation supported a useful choice. Do not measure success by whether the other person agreed, explained or changed their attitude.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.cci.health.wa.gov.au/Resources/Looking-After-Yourself/Assertiveness

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